LDT581:

The information contained on this page is designed to give students a representative example of material covered in the course. Any information related to course assignments, dates, or course materials is illustrative only. For a definitive list of materials, please check the online catalog 3-4 weeks before the course start date.

LDT 581 Theoretical Foundations of Learning, Design, and Technology

LDT 581 *Theoretical Foundations of Learning, Design, and Technology* (3 credits) is an analysis of theoretical foundations of the instructional systems (systems and cybernetics, communications, cognitive psychology, sociological, constructivist, ecological) for doctoral and masters students.

Overview | Objectives | Materials | Library Resources | Technical Requirements and Help | Course Requirements and Grading | Course Schedule | Academic Integrity | Student Success and Support Resources | Additional Policies

Overview

In this course we will read, discuss, and develop our notions of how people learn. We will be looking at contemporary empirical and theoretical work that tries to elucidate the complex issues surrounding learning—what it might look like, how it happens, and how might we design or evaluate it. The manuscripts that we will be reading present accounts of learning from various contexts (formal and informal) and for various populations (children to adults), and we will try to articulate the individual, social, and cultural aspects of learning as we go through the semester.

Course Objectives

Here are the course goals for LDT 581:

- Identify various theoretical positions on how people learn.
- Analyze different views of learning to understand how they articulate and theorize human behavior.
- Develop and articulate your view of learning.

Required Course Materials

All course materials are accessible within the course. There is no required textbook for LDT 581.

E-Reserves

This course requires that you access Penn State library materials specifically reserved for this course. You can access these materials by selecting Library Resources in your course navigation, or by accessing the Library E-Reserves Search (ht

tps://guides-libraries-psu-edu.ezaccess.libraries.psu.edu/er.php?b=c) and search for your instructor's last name.

Library Resources

Many of the University Libraries resources can be utilized from a distance. Through the Libraries website, you can

- access magazine, journal, and newspaper articles online using library databases;
- borrow materials and have them delivered to your doorstep—or even your desktop;
- get research help via email, chat, or phone using the Ask a Librarian service; and
- much more.

You must have an active Penn State Access Account to take full advantage of the Libraries' resources and service. The Off-Campus Users page (https://libraries.psu.edu/world) has additional information about these free services.

Technical Requirements and Help

Technical Requirements and Help

Operating System	Canvas, Penn State's Learning Management System (LMS), supports most recent versions of Microsoft Windows and Apple Mac operating systems. To determine if your operating system is supported, please review Canvas' computer specifications (https://community.instructure.com/en/kb/articles/662718-what-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-instructure-products) .
Browser	Canvas supports the last two versions of every major browser release. It is highly recommended that you update to the newest version of whatever browser you are using. Please note that Canvas does not support the use of Internet Explorer. Students and instructors should choose a different browser to use. To determine if your browser is supported, please review the list of Canvas Supported Browsers (https://community.instructure.com/en/kb/articles/662718-what-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-instructure-products) . --- **Note**: Cookies must be enabled, and pop-up blockers should be configured to permit new windows from Penn State websites.
Additional Canvas Requirements	For a list of software, hardware, and computer settings specifically required by the Canvas LMS, please review Canvas' computer specifications (https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Basics-Guide/What-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-Instructure/ta-p/66) .

Additional Software	All Penn State students have access to Microsoft Office 365 (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/a-z-index/office-365) , including Microsoft Office applications such as Word, Excel, and PowerPoint. Students will need a PDF reader, such as Adobe Reader (https://get.adobe.com/reader/) .
Hardware	**Monitor:** Monitor capable of at least 1024 x 768 resolution **Audio:** Microphone, Speakers **Camera** (optional, recommended)**:** Standard webcam **-** many courses may require a webcam for assignments or exam proctoring software.
Mobile Device (optional)	The Canvas mobile app is available for versions of iOS and Android. To determine if your device is capable of using the Canvas Mobile App, please review the Canvas Mobile App Requirements (https://community.instructure.com/en/kb/articles/388741-unknown) .
Help	If you need technical assistance at any point during the course, please contact the Service Desk (https://www.it.psu.edu/support/) .

Student Education Experience Questionnaire (SEEQ)

During the semester you will receive information about completing the Student Education Experience Questionnaire (SEEQ). Your participation is an opportunity to provide anonymous feedback on your learning experience. Your feedback is important because it allows us to understand your experience in this course and make changes to improve the learning experiences of future students. Please monitor email and course communications for links and availability dates.

Course Requirements and Grading

Requirements

A Note about Course Pathways

This course is designed to provide as much agency as possible. As a result, there are two pathways to choose from in terms of how you go about this course—individually or dialogically/collaboratively. Pathways give you more agency to choose the kind of learning experience you need at this stage of your academic and professional career.

The individual pathway provides you with the opportunity to read, write, and submit required assignments in a way that empowers you individually as a learner. That is, there is less interaction with your instructor or classmates and more focus on your unique needs, particularly in terms of balancing other aspects of your student–professional life. You are graded by pre-established rubrics, which also act as forms of feedback for your next paper or project.

The dialogic pathway demands interaction and collaboration. It is dialogic in the sense that your learning emerges through dialog with your instructor and peers as co-learners. As such, your instructor is positioned less as an external evaluator and more as learning companion. This is a critical shift. Assignments center on interaction, guiding you to engage with your

instructor through self-assessment letters and with your peers through discussion. There are no rubrics because so-called assignments will be tailored to your individual needs and goals as the semester progresses. Your final "grade" stems from ongoing self-assessment.

The *dialogic pathway* is the default for the course. You are encouraged to reflect on the kind of experience you would like from this course and then let your instructor know how you would like to proceed by the end of the first week.

Checkpoints

Personal Learning History (Living Document)

Inspired by the Rose reading in the second week, you will describe your own history of learning something (or, learning to be someone), whether it is to be a waiter or waitress, like in the reading, or a teacher, skateboarder, ornithologist, or something else. The goal here, again following Rose, is to begin to examine deeply your own learning over time, across settings, by didactic teaching, informal digital learning, and so on. This document (ideally housed in a Google Doc) will be alive for us—that is, we will return to it as we encounter new readings (dates in syllabus), annotating our old writing with comments informed by our current moment in the course. To begin, you should aim for about 750–1,000 words.

Process Letter/Artifact

This self-assessment (process) letter is a chance for you to describe your own learning, interests, thoughts, and reflections as the course progresses. While these are, by nature, open-ended, they should serve as an opportunity for you to work through the material, synthesizing key ideas that stand out to you (not all will!). Again, the dialogic nature of these letters means that there is not necessarily a "right way" to do this, or that your instructor has an "ideal version" in mind—everyone's will look different based on their own perspectives on the relevant reading and interactions they have had with classmates and the instructor. These are likely around 500 words and can be less formal than other writing assignments.

One example of this kind of letter would be a Google Doc with embedded commentary. The letter itself might synthesize key ideas from the reading, passages that you find intriguing or challenging, or ideas that connect or disconnect with previous reading. Using the comment function in Google Docs, you might leave more “informal” thoughts that invite dialog with your instructor or others.

You are also invited and encouraged to test out other forms of media (e.g., Adobe Spark).

Here is an example process letter (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1-iTvVG-zCETgaC1PTcgCbrAIp5pS-lYOPCWfcyHjmQU/edit) if you're looking for a starting point.

Important note: *These are not reading summaries*. Reading summaries are a particular genre of writing for courses and have their benefits and drawbacks. In this course, we'll work to synthesize ideas, over time, not necessarily summarize them. This is not a way to prove you have read everything in-depth: that's simply an expectation. Here, we focus on what YOU care most about, the lines and passages that resonate or inspire you, that let you make connections with (or run counter to!) other readings and experiences you have had.

Weekly Engagement

Every week, we will be discussing the articles we have read. Please be prepared for this engagement to occur every week and be sure to read the detailed activity list presented for each week. You should plan for the engagement to occur between Saturday and Tuesday of the week, although some might span longer periods of time.

Some weeks, engagement is stimulated by critical questions, videos, or artifacts arising from and related to the readings; some weeks, it's stimulated by your reading of peers' self-assessments. Throughout the semester, certain weeks will focus on dialogs based on question prompts. The goal of these dialogs is not necessarily that you answer the question, but that you engage in discussion with group members about areas of inquiry that are important to you. Thus, the guiding questions really are mere prompts with the hope that further examination of ideas from the texts leads to new questions and responses among group members.

Please note that the weekly engagement includes your own posts as well as responses to peers, which are specified in each week's discussion requirement.

Discussions work best when there's some back-and-forth among everyone. So don't feel pressured to write long missives in response to prompts or readings; instead, focus on the key ideas that you want to generate discussion around, or questions that you're hoping to hear others' perspectives on. It's more like letting a seed grow over time rather than planting a fully-bloomed plant.

Infographic (Collaborative)

In this collaborative project, you and your group members will create (lesson 3) and revise (lesson 7) an infographic that summarizes the key learning theories covered to that point in the course. Piktochart (https://piktochart.com/) is one tool that enables you to do this easily, although it is asynchronous, so feel free to use any others that you are familiar with. Here are examples of some of the supposed best infographics (https://www.creativebloq.com/graphic-design-tips/information-graphics-1232836) that might serve as inspiration.

Learning Community Analysis (Collaborative)

Early in the semester, your group will choose one learning community (likely an online community) to analyze based on the theories you encounter (and have encountered) throughout the semester. For instance, your group might choose to follow a specific YouTube channel to examine the learning principles at play on it. Or you might choose to follow a Twitter hashtag (like #literacies) over time to see how people engage with one another. Or you might choose to play an online game together and immerse yourself in the world over time. At the end of the semester, you'll submit a collaboratively written document (likely a Google Doc) that reports some of your findings in relation to our readings.

Final Paper and Meta-Reflection/Self-Assessment

The final paper has two options—one is more application-oriented, while the second is more research-oriented. In consultation with your instructor, you can decide which is best suited for your specific interests and professional goals. For example, if your future or immediate career goals are focused on design, you may be better served by choosing Option 1, whereas Option 2 would serve you better if you plan to conduct research. Whichever option you choose, the paper should be written for a formal academic audience, should adhere to APA style, and should range in length from 5 to 7 double-spaced pages (excluding title and references).

Option 1. Learning Theory and Design White Paper

This white paper enables you to synthesize material from this semester and direct it toward the potential design or revitalization of a specific context that is meaningful to you. The Connected Learning (https://dmlhub.net/publications/connected-learning-agenda-for-research-and-design/) white paper can serve as an example. Click the blue "Free Download" button on the page to download the eBook at no cost. Your white paper should focus on how learning theory applies to design, so make sure to address the following items:

- Provide a succinct **definition of learning** based on what you have read in this course. How do you define learning, and how does it occur? Make sure to cite materials and papers from the course clearly and show how you draw upon them to formulate your definition. Also clarify the role of the individual and the social and cultural context of learning within your definition.
- Identify a specific **context** within which you would like to design, implement, and evaluate learning—for example, a face-to-face classroom in a K–12 context, an informal (face-to-face or online) group for adults to explore their interests on a hobby or other leisure topic, a formal online classroom for higher education, or something else. Describe the context in terms of the environment, the learners, and the experts.
- Identify a possible **learning goal** that you would like to pursue within your context.
- Explore at least **one design scenario** to reach the proposed learning goal. The design should be based on learning theory, especially the definition you have proposed. Specifically address how you plan to design or modify the learning context/environment and what learners and instructors/experts will be doing, and explain how that is aligned with learning theory.
- Explain **how you could examine whether and how learning is occurring** in your context. What are the processes or interactions that will occur in your context that might signify learning? How might you assess whether these processes contribute to learning of the content or other important related skills?

Option 2. Framework for Research on Learning Paper

This second paper is geared toward PhD students, those interested in research, or those who would prefer to primarily synthesize ideas from the course. This paper should focus on a theoretical and conceptual explication of learning and how it applies to research on learning, and it should address the following items:

- Provide a succinct definition of learning based on what you have read in this course. How do you define learning, and how does it occur? Make sure to cite materials and papers from the course clearly and show how you draw upon them to formulate your definition. Also clarify the role of the individual and the social and cultural context of learning within your definition.
- Identify a specific research context within which you want to examine and research learning. This may be a face-to-face K–12 classroom, a summer camp or after-school program for kids/youth, a formal online course for adults, or something else. Describe the context and its participants, both learners and experts. Identify your specific research interest in this context.
- Based on the texts you have read in this course as well as any additional resources you have accessed, describe a theoretical and conceptual framework for examining learning in your context. What is a possible theoretical lens you could apply to this context? Is it primarily cognitive, behavioral, sociocultural, or something else? Why is that an appropriate lens?
- Based on the theoretical framework identified, describe how you might assess the processes and outcomes within your context. For example, if you are using a primarily sociocultural lens to examine your context, you might focus on the roles of novices and experts and how they interact and change over time. Also describe how your assessment is consistent with the specific theoretical and conceptual bases you have drawn upon.

Meta-Reflection on Learning and Self-Assessment

Highlight instances in your work throughout the semester that demonstrate growth and putting forth what you believe is an adequate representation of your work in this class. Based on your reflections, you'll conclude with a final self-assessment which your instructor will either ratify as your final grade or dialogue with you about it.

Toward "Ungrading"

The pathways for this course and their subsequent assessments are, in part, inspired by recent calls to "ungrade" education. These calls challenge the methods that have been accepted—and expected—in terms of how learning is evaluated. You can learn more on the following website about steps others have taken toward "ungrading (https://www.jessestommel.com/how-to-ungrade/) ." Because this is a course on learning theory, the intention is that we are reflective on all aspects of our own learning in this course—from individual to collaborative assignments, to the dynamics of group discussion, to the role of a so-called instructor, and, as evidenced here, on evaluations of learning.

Rather than operating by letter grade (as much as possible), "assessment" on the dialogic pathway stems from your ongoing self-assessment letters as well as your dialogs with your instructor and peers. Those dialogs should collaboratively illuminate areas in which you are excelling as well as areas in which you can continue to improve. The dialogic pathways assume that you will complete the work as best as you can (or as best as you want to) and that you will reflect on that work in a way that pushes your own thinking forward for future assignments (as well as future courses, or future career opportunities, or more). You can use the following framework as a general guidepost. In the end, while your instructor reserves the right to give a final grade, the choice is up to you. Following Stommel (2017), this course operates under the belief "that asking students to give themselves a grade also makes the why and how of grades a valuable subject of the conversations we have—valuable because they will go on to be graded in other courses and thinking critically about how and why grading happens helps that become more productive for them."

Letter Grade	Criteria
Exceptional (A)	Your work is exceptional. You thoughtfully and creatively demonstrate deep understanding of the key concepts and ideas, surpassing course expectations. You relate your learning to prior knowledge, seminal work in educational theory, and empirical research and explicitly recognized implications of these ideas/concepts and their application for your future and/or broader practice. Your work generates little critique and exceeds ALL criteria for assignments and the course.
Very well done (A−)	Your work is very well done. You utilize feedback and demonstrate you are developing and deepening your understanding of key concepts. You describe your learning in relation to prior knowledge in creative and nuanced ways. Your work generates few questions/critiques and exceeds NEARLY ALL criteria for assignments and the course.
Meets and partially exceeds expectation (B+)	Your work meets all and exceeds some criteria for the assignments and course. There is evidence of a deepening understanding and an effort and commitment to thinking critically about the ideas, concepts, and topics as they might be applied in practice.
Meets expectations (B)	Your work meets all criteria for the assessment and/or the course. You include all necessary pieces/parts and adequately address each aspect of the expectations that have been conveyed to you. Your work demonstrates mastery in all targeted areas of competency.

Letter Grade	Criteria
Acceptable (C)	Your work partially addresses some of the criteria or has pieces missing but is acceptable. Your work includes some evidence that feedback on prior assessments and experiences (e.g., discussions, tasks, etc.) in class have been thoughtfully applied. Individual instructors have the discretion to request or accept revision of work at this level.

Grading Scale

The following grading scale will be used to determine your overall course grade.

Grading Scale

Percentage	Letter grade
93-100	A
90-92.9	A-
86-89.9	B+
83-85.9	B
80-82.9	B-
77-79.9	C+
70-76.9	C
60-69.9	D
0-59.9	F

Please refer to the University Registrar's (https://www.registrar.psu.edu/grades/index.cfm) information about University grading policies.

If, for reasons beyond the student's control, a student is prevented from completing a course within the prescribed time, the grade in that course may be deferred with the concurrence of the instructor. The symbol DF appears on the student's transcript until the course has been completed. Non-emergency permission for filing a deferred grade must be requested by the student before the beginning of the final examination period. In an emergency situation, an instructor can approve a deferred grade after the final exam period has started. Under emergency conditions during which the instructor is unavailable, authorization is required from one of the following: the dean of the college in which the candidate is enrolled; the executive director of the Division of Undergraduate Studies if the student is enrolled in that division or is a provisional student; or the campus chancellor of the student's associated Penn State campus.

For additional information please refer to the Deferring a Grade (http://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/deferring-grade) page.

Course Schedule

Tutoring Resources

Writing and technology tutoring resources are available to World Campus students. Writing Tutoring (https://pennstatelearning.psu.edu/writing) is available through Penn State Learning, and Technology Tutors (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/course-work-and-success/technology-and-software) are available through Information Technology Services (ITS) Training Services.Note: If you are planning to graduate this semester, please communicate your intent to graduate to your instructor. This will alert your instructor to the need to submit your final grade in time to meet the published graduation deadlines. For more information about graduation policies and deadlines, please refer to Graduation (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/graduating-students/graduation) at the Chaiken Center for Student Success.

Note: All due dates reflect North American eastern time (ET).

This schedule outlines the topics we will be covering in this course, along with the associated time frames, readings, and assignments. **Note**: Lesson weeks start on Wednesday morning and end on Tuesday evening in this course.

To access articles on the E-Reserves, select Library Resources in your course navigation, or browse the Library E-Reserves Search (https://guides-libraries-psu-edu.ezaccess.libraries.psu.edu/er.php?b=c) and search for your instructor's last name.

Lesson 1: Orientation

Readings	• None
Assignments	• Introduce yourself in Lesson 1 Discussion. • Fill out the Profile Survey. • Be sure to carefully read syllabus and alert instructor if you choose the **individual pathway**.

Lesson 2: Everyday Perspectives and Overview

Readings	• Rose, M. (2001). The working life of a waitress. *Mind, Culture, and Activity, 8*(1), 3–27. https://doi.org/10.1207/S15327884MCA0801_02 • Driscoll, M. (2005). Chapter 1: Introduction to theories of learning and instruction. *Psychology of learning for instruction* (pp. 1–29). Pearson. **Available on E-Reserves.**
Assignments	• Lesson 2 Discussion: React to “Working Life of a Waitress” in your assigned group. • Submit Version 1.0 of your Personal Learning History (Living Document).

Lesson 3: Behaviorism, Cognitivism, and Constructivism

Readings	• Yilmaz, K. (2011). The cognitive perspective on learning: Its theoretical underpinnings and implications for classroom practices. *The Clearing House*, *84*(1), 204–212. https://doi.org/10.1080/00098655.2011.568989 • Driscoll, M. (2005). Chapter 2: Radical behaviorism. *Psychology of learning for Instruction* (pp. 29–69). Pearson. **Available on E-Reserves.** • Sherin, B. (2017). Constructivist learning. In K. Peppler (Ed.), *Sage encyclopedia of out-of-school learning* (pp. 374-381). Sage.
Assignments	• With your group, create an infographic (or related visualization) for behaviorist, cognitivist, and constructivist perspectives and share to Slack in the **#sharing** channel.

Lesson 4: Situated Cognition

Readings	• Brown, J. S., Collins, A., & Duguid, P. (1989). Situated cognition and the culture of learning. *Educational Researcher*, *18*(1), 32–42. https://doi.org/10.3102%2F0013189X018001032 • Cognition and Technology Group at Vanderbilt. (1990). Anchored instruction and its relationship to situated cognition. *Educational Researcher*, *19*(6), 2–10. https://doi.org/10.3102%2F0013189X019006002
Assignments	• Submit Process Letter #1 (described in syllabus).

Lesson 5: Situated Learning and Communities of Practice

Readings	• Esmonde, I. (2016). Power and sociocultural theories of learning (p. 6-27). In Esmonde, I., & Booker, A. N. (Eds.). (2016). *Power and privilege in the learning sciences: Critical and sociocultural theories of learning*. Taylor & Francis. **Available on E-Reserves.** • Lave, J. (1991). Situating learning in communities of practice. *Perspectives on Socially Shared Cognition, 2*, 63–82. **Available on E-Reserves.**
Assignments	• Lesson 5 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 6: Theory-Into-Practice

Readings	**Available on E-Reserves:** Note: Choose two of the following to read, based on emerging interests: • Expansions on theory: ◦ Family Learning (Brahms) ◦ CHAT (Roth) ◦ Apprenticeship (Hay) ◦ Learning Pathways (Kirshner et al.) ◦ Everyday Expertise (Zimmerman) • Theory enacted in specific settings: ◦ Fifth Dimension (Cole) ◦ Computer Clubhouses (Rusk & Resnick) ◦ La Clase Magica (Vasquez & Telles) ◦ YouMedia (Pinkard)
Assignments	• Lesson 6 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 7: Reflection and Process Report

Readings	• No new readings this week.
Assignments	• Refine and revise the infographic concept maps created in the previous weeks to include situated/sociocultural theories. Post revised version to Slack in the **#sharing** channel. • Report / check in with group on Learning Community Analysis (This template can help jump-st art analysis and discussion (https://docs.google.com/document/d/1T5pwenBPs20qLamtGPfsIi5e3O1Kjz2NffZd-H4dBYo/edit)). • Submit Process Letter #2 (described in syllabus).

Lesson 8: Critical Perspectives

Readings	• Freire, P. (1987). Chapter 1 (http://www.historyisaweapon.com/defcon2/pedagogy/pedagogychapter1.html) . *Pedagogy of the Oppressed*. • hooks, b. (1994). Chapter 2: Engaged pedagogy (https://academictrap.files.wordpress.com/2015/03/bell-hooks-teaching-to-transgress.pdf) . *Teaching to transgress: Education as the practice of freedom* (pp. 13–22). Routledge. • Stommel, J. (2017). *If bell hooks made an LMS: Grades, radical openness, and domain of one's own (https://www.jessestommel.com/if-bell-hooks-made-an-lms-grades-radical-openness-and-domain-of-ones-own/)* . https://www.jessestommel.com/if-bell-hooks-made-an-lms-grades-radical-openness-and-domain-of-ones-own. • Hall, T. (2017). Critical Race Theory. In K. Peppler (Ed.), *Sage encyclopedia of out-of-school learning* (pp. 167-172). Sage.
Assignments	• Lesson 8 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 9: Culture and Diversity

Readings	• Moll, L. C., Amanti, C., Neff, D., & Gonzalez, N. (1992). Funds of knowledge for teaching: Using a qualitative approach to connect homes and classrooms. *Theory into Practice*, *31*(2), 132–141. https://doi.org/10.1080/00405849209543534 • Nasir, N. I. S., & Cooks, J. (2009). Becoming a hurdler: How learning settings afford identities. *Anthropology & Education Quarterly*, *40*(1), 41-61.
Assignments	• Lesson 9 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 10: Informal Learning

Readings	• Rogoff, B., Callanan, M., Gutierrez, K. D., & Erickson, F. (2016). The organization of informal learning. *Review of Research in Education, 40*(1), 356-401. https://doi.org/10.3102%2F0091732X16680994
Assignments	• Lesson 10 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 11: From Informal to Connected Learning

Readings	• Choose one of the following: ◦ WWE Fandom and connected learning (https://web.archive.org/web/20250805044855/https://dmlhub.net/publications/learning-ropes-connected-learning-wwe-fan-community/) ◦ YouMedia Chicago and connected learning (https://web.archive.org/web/20250428154729/https://dmlhub.net/publications/safe-space-and-shared-interests-youmedia-chicago-laboratory-connected-learning/) ◦ Starcraft gameplay and connected learning (https://web.archive.org/web/20240327032128/https://dmlhub.net/publications/crafting-metagame-connected-learning-starcraft-ii-community/) ◦ Civic engagement (via Harry Potter knitting) and connected learning (https://web.archive.org/web/20240419221412/https://dmlhub.net/publications/hats-house-elves-connected-learning-and-civic-engagement-hogwarts-ravelry/) ◦ Fashion design programs and connected learning (https://web.archive.org/web/20250817000108/https://dmlhub.net/publications/fashioning-learning-connected-learning-through-fashion-design-programs/) • Ito, M., Gutiérrez, K., Livingstone, S., Penuel, B., Rhodes, J., Salen, K., Schor, J., Sefton-Green, J., & Watkins, S. C. (2013). Part 2: Connected learning. In *Connected learning: An agenda for research and design* (pp. 32–87). Digital Media and Learning Research Hub. **Available on E-Reserves.**
Assignments	• Submit Process Letter #3 (described in syllabus).

Lesson 12: Reflection and Process Report

Readings	• No new readings this week.
Assignments	• Report / check in with group on Learning Community Analysis. • Submit Personal Learning History 2.0 (as annotations in original document).

Lesson 13: Interest-Driven Threads

Readings	• **Informal Learning**: Barron, B. (2006). Interest and self-sustained learning as catalysts of development: A learning ecology perspective. *Human Development, 49*(4), 193–224. https://doi.org/10.1159/000094368 • **Critical Perspectives**: ◦ Kumashiro, K. K. (2000). Toward a theory of anti-oppressive education. *Review of Educational Research, 70*(1), 25–53. http://ezaccess.libraries.psu.edu/login?url=https://www-proquest-com.ezaccess.libraries.psu.edu/docview/214114515 ◦ Paris, D. (2012). Culturally sustaining pedagogy: A needed change in stance, terminology, and practice. *Educational Researcher, 41*(3), 93–97. https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X12441244 • **Sociocultural Theories of Learning**: Rogoff, B., Paradise, R., Arauz, R. M., Correa-Chávez, M., & Angelillo, C. (2003). Firsthand learning through intent participation. *Annual Review of Psychology, 54*(1), 175–203. https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev.psych.54.101601.145118 • Explore LOPI Website (https://learningbyobservingandpitchingin.sites.ucsc.edu/overview/) , including videos.
Assignments	• None

Lesson 14: Interest-Driven Threads Continued

Readings	• **Informal Learning**: Crowley, K., & Jacobs, M. (2002). Building islands of expertise in everyday family activity (https://www.lrdc.pitt.edu/mlc/documents/mlc-05a.pdf) . *Learning conversations in museums*. Lawrence Erlbaum Associates. • **Critical Perspectives**: Harris, A., & Leonardo, Z. (2018). Intersectionality, race-gender subordination, and education. *Review of Research in Education*, *42*(1), 1-27. • **Sociocultural Theories of Learning**: Lave, J. (2008). Epilogue: Situated learning and changing practice. In A. Amin & J. Roberts (Eds.), *Community, economic creativity, and organization* (pp. 283–296). Oxford University Press. **Available on E-Reserves.**
Assignments	• Lesson 14 Discussion: Discuss perspectives presented by the articles in your assigned group.

Lesson 15: Reflecting on Learning and Theories of Learning

Readings	• None.
Assignments	• Final Paper with embedded annotations • Meta-Reflection on Learning and Self-Assessment. • Learning Community Analysis.

Formal instruction will end on the last day of class. Provided that you have an active Penn State Access Account user ID and password, you will continue to be able to access the course materials for one year, starting from the end date of the academic semester in which the course was offered (with the exception of library reserves and other external resources that may have a shorter archival period). After one year, you might be able to access the course based on the policies of the program or department offering the course material, up to a maximum of three years from the end date of the academic semester in which the course was offered. For more information, please review the University Course Archival Policy (https://pennstate.service-now.com/sp?id=kb_article_view&sysparm_article=KB0022219) .

Academic Integrity

According to Penn State policy G-9: Academic Integrity (https://aappm.psu.edu/policy/g-9-academic-integrity) (for undergraduate students in undergraduate courses) and policy GCAC-805 Academic Integrity (https://gradschool.psu.edu/graduate-education-policies/gcac/gcac-800/gcac-805-academic-integrity) (for graduate students and undergraduate students in graduate courses), an academic integrity violation is “an intentional, unintentional, or attempted violation of course or assessment policies to gain an academic advantage or to advantage or disadvantage another student academically.” Unless your instructor tells you otherwise, you must complete all course work entirely on your own, using only sources that have been permitted by your instructor, and you may not assist other students with papers, quizzes, exams, or other assessments. If your instructor allows you to use ideas, images, or word phrases created by another person (e.g., from Course Hero or Chegg) or by generative technology, such as ChatGPT, you must identify their source. You may not submit false or fabricated information, use the same academic work for credit in multiple courses, or share instructional content. Students with questions about academic integrity should ask their instructor **before submitting work.**

Students facing allegations of academic misconduct may not drop/withdraw from the affected course unless they are cleared of wrongdoing (see G-9: Academic Integrity (https://aappm.psu.edu/policy/g-9-academic-integrity) or GCAC-805 Academic Integrity (https://gradschool.psu.edu/graduate-education-policies/gcac/gcac-800/gcac-805-academic-integrity) as appropriate). Attempted drops will be prevented or reversed, and students will be expected to complete course work and meet course deadlines. Students who are found responsible for academic integrity violations face academic outcomes, which can be severe, and put themselves at jeopardy for other outcomes which may include ineligibility for Dean’s List, pass/fail elections, and grade forgiveness. Students may also face consequences from their home/major program and/or The Schreyer Honors College.

How Academic Integrity Violations Are Handled
World Campus students are expected to act with civility and personal integrity; respect other students' dignity, rights, and property; and help create and maintain an environment in which all can succeed through the fruits of their own efforts. An environment of academic integrity is requisite to respect for oneself and others, as well as a civil community.

In cases where academic integrity is questioned, procedures allow a student to accept or contest/appeal the allegation. If a student chooses to contest/appeal the allegation, the case will then be managed by the respective school, college or campus Academic Integrity Committee. Review procedures may vary by college, campus, or school, but all follow the aforementioned policies.

All academic integrity violations are referred to the Office of Student Accountability and Conflict Response (https://studentaffairs.psu.edu/student-accountability) , which may assign an educational intervention and/or apply a Formal Warning, Conduct Probation, Suspension, or Expulsion.

Information about Penn State's academic integrity policy is included in the information that students receive upon enrolling in a course. To obtain that information in advance of enrolling in a course, please contact us by going to the Contacts & Help page (http://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/contacts-help-current-students) .

Student Success and Support Resources

The Chaiken Center for Student Success at Penn State World Campus (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/) guides you to the right resources and support you need–when you need them–along your academic journey. You can connect with peers and support teams to find direction, information, and networking opportunities. On the website, you'll find information and resources on many aspects of being a World Campus student:

- **Finances**—tuition, scholarships, and financial aid
- **Inclusion and Wellness**—diversity and inclusion, mental health services, disability accommodations, care and advocacy
- **Enrollment and Registration—**course planning, adding and dropping courses, and much more
- **Course Work and Success—**academic advising, tutoring, and other services
- **Involvement and Opportunities—**career resources, student organizations, internships, service, study abroad, and more

Following are some key resources.

Student Disability Services

Penn State welcomes students with disabilities, whether permanent or temporary, visible or hidden, into the University's educational programs. Every Penn State campus has an office for students with disabilities, including World Campus. The Disabilities and Accommodations (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/inclusion-and-wellness/disabilities-and-accommodations) section of the Chaiken Center for Student Success website provides World Campus students with information regarding how to request accommodations, documentation guidelines and eligibility, and appeals and complaints. For additional information, please visit the University's Student Disability Resources website (http://equity.psu.edu/sdr) .

In order to receive consideration for reasonable accommodations, you must contact the appropriate disability services office (https://equity.psu.edu/offices/student-disability-resources/campus-offices) at the campus where you are officially enrolled, participate in an intake interview, and provide documentation. If the documentation supports your request for reasonable accommodations, your campus's disability services office will provide you with an accommodation letter. Please share this letter with your instructors and discuss the accommodations with them as early in your courses as possible. You must follow this process for every semester that you request accommodations.

Graduate students: Please see the Student Disability Resources website for graduate student resources (https://equity.psu.edu/offices/student-disability-resources/graduate-students-with-disabilities) .

Students with disabilities participating in internship, practicum, student teaching, or other experiential learning opportunities as part of their degree requirements may also be eligible for reasonable accommodations to ensure equal access and opportunity. These accommodations are determined through an interactive process involving the student, their University supervisor, and the site supervisor. Student Disability Resources can assist students with identifying potential barriers, facilitating accommodation requests, and coordinating with University supervisors to promote inclusive learning experiences.

Counseling and Psychological Services

If you have a crisis or safety concern, mental health services (http://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/inclusion-and-wellness/mental-health) are available to you as a Penn State student. Crisis and emergency contacts (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/help-and-support/crisis-and-emergency-help) are available, no matter where you are located:

- **Anywhere in the United States:** Call the Penn State Crisis Line at 1-877-229-6400 or text LIONS to 741741. You can also contact your local crisis services or hospital for emergencies.
- **Outside the United States**: Please contact emergency services in your current location. You can also use the International Crisis and Emergency Services listings (https://findahelpline.com/) .
- **At University Park:** Assistance is available at Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS) locations (https://studentaffairs.psu.edu/counseling/UP-locations) on campus.
- **At a Penn State branch campus:** You can search for counseling information at your campus (https://studentaffairs.psu.edu/counseling/caps-campuses) .

Military Student Information

Veterans and currently serving military personnel and/or dependents with unique circumstances (e.g., upcoming deployments, drill/duty requirements, VA appointments, etc.) are welcome and encouraged to communicate these, in advance if possible, to the instructor in the case that special arrangements need to be made.

Additional Policies

Privacy Notice

In order to protect your privacy, course access is limited to those individuals who have direct responsibility for the quality of your educational experience. In addition to the instructor, a teaching assistant or college administrator may be provided access in order to ensure optimal faculty availability and access. World Campus technical staff may also be given access in order to resolve technical support issues.

Student Responsibilities and Conduct

1. Students are responsible for online course content, taking notes, obtaining other materials provided by the instructor, taking tests (if applicable), and completing assignments as scheduled by the instructor. As a general rule, students should plan on logging into the course at least three times per week and spending at least three hours per course credit per week on the course, e.g., if the course is three credits, the student should plan on spending at least 9-12 hours per week on the course, just as they would in a residence course.
2. Students are responsible for keeping track of changes in the course syllabus made by the instructor throughout the semester.
3. Students are responsible for monitoring their grades.
4. Students must contact their instructor (and teammates when working on any collaborative learning assignments) as soon as possible if they anticipate missing long periods of online time due to events such as chronic illnesses, death in the family, business travel, or other appropriate events. The instructor will determine the minimal log on time and participation required in order to meet course responsibilities. In the event of other unforeseen conflicts, the instructor and student will arrive at a solution together.

a. Instructors may require students to provide documentation with the class absence form or other written notification for events such as illness, family emergency, or a business-sanctioned activity.

b. Conflicts with dates on which examinations or assignments are scheduled must be discussed with the instructor or TA (teaching assistant) prior to the date of the examination or assignment.

5. Students are responsible for following appropriate netiquette (network etiquette) when communicating with their instructor and classmates. For reference, see the Academic Success Kit (https://student.worldcampus.psu.edu/course-work-and-success/academic-skills) .
6. Behaviors that disrupt other students' learning are not acceptable and will be addressed by the instructor.
7. For severe and chronic problems with student disruptive behavior, the following will be applied for resolution:
    a. Senate Committee on Student Life policy on managing classroom disruptions: Office of Student Accountability and Conflict Response. (https://studentaffairs.psu.edu/student-accountability)

    b. Penn State Values. (https://universityethics.psu.edu/penn-state-values)

Report Bias

Penn State takes great pride to foster a diverse and inclusive environment for students, faculty, and staff. Acts of intolerance, discrimination, or harassment due to age, ancestry, color, disability, gender, gender identity, national origin, race, religious belief, sexual orientation, or veteran status are not tolerated and can be reported through Educational Equity via the Report Bias webpage (http://equity.psu.edu/reportbias/) .

Please direct questions to the IT Service Desk (https://www.it.psu.edu/support/) | The Pennsylvania State University © 2026